

BHARATI GAONKER

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Summary:

Highly skilled Research Associate with 3+ years of experience in clinical and biomedical research, molecular biology, and biomarker analysis. Adept at designing and executing assays using PCR, MS-LC, ISH/FISH, and operating automated liquid handling systems (Leica, Ventana, Hamilton) in GMP/cGMP-compliant laboratories. Strong expertise in LIMS, regulatory compliance (CLIA, CAPA, HIPAA, GCLP), and scientific data analysis. Demonstrated ability to collaborate with cross-functional teams, manage sample inventory, troubleshoot laboratory processes, and drive process improvements. Published researcher with a Master's in Biological Sciences and hands-on experience in bioinformatics, biostatistical tools, and technical writing. Passionate about leveraging cutting-edge research methodologies to support drug discovery, oncology, and cell & gene therapy advancements.

Key Skills

- Clinical & Biomedical Research
- SOP& Regulatory Compliance
- Perform Assays Using Robots/Liquid Analyzers like Leica, Ventana and Hamilton
- Biomarker Analysis
- Design & Execute Assays using PCR, MS-LC, ISH/FISH molecular techniques
- Sample Management
- LIMS
- Stakeholder & Internal/External Vendor Communication
- Scientific Data Review & Analysis
- Reagent Testing and Validation
- GMP/cGMP
- CAPA
- Deviation
- Investigation
- Root cause Analysis
- Bioreactor Maintenance, Operation & Calibration
- Streamlining & Executing SOP Amends
- Biomedical Experimentation
- BSL2 biosafety level
- Laboratory Maintenance for Audit Compliance
- Scientific Writing & Presentation
- Data Analysis Using Various Bio-Statistical/Informatic Tools & Software

Education

M.S. Biological Sciences | Dominican University of California

Published Thesis | <https://doi.org/10.33015/dominican.edu/2021.BIO.09>

B.Sc Life Sciences | Karnatak University India

WES Badge | International Degree Equivalency

Coursera Certifications

- Bioinformatic Methods I -September 2020
- Bioinformatic Methods II -September 2020
- Plant Bioinformatics -December 2020
- Biosafety Training – Faculty and Students
- Student Researchers RCR

Professional Experience

ACD Bio-Techne, Newark CA

Aug 2021 to Dec 2023

Research Associate

- Spearheaded clinical and bio-medical research studies for multiple clients, ensuring compliance with **SOPs and regulatory guidelines in a BSL2 biosafety level CLIA/CAPA/HIPAA/GCLP/cGMP** compliant laboratory, and preparing scientific findings for client and stake holder presentations independently alongside scientists and leadership teams.
- Expertly managed advanced manual and automated platforms for RNA target biomarker analysis using cutting-edge RNAscope/Basescope Technologies based on ISH/FISH for **chromatography on Leica, Ventana and Hamilton liquid**

handler robots, delivering critical data for top-tier biotech, academic, and pharmaceutical manufacturing stakeholders in drug discovery, oncology, immuno-oncology, T-cell, B-Cell and other cell and gene-based therapy, single small molecule target distribution, transitional medicine, clinical, pre-clinical, studies in several therapeutic areas.

- **Maintained constant communication with clients through conference calls, emails, and customized reports, collaborating with internal teams to deliver scientific studies within set timelines and ensure quality data provision.**
- Reviewed scientific studies, participated in **technical troubleshooting** and discussions, managed sample inventory, and tracked samples for shipment back to clients, adhering to process guidelines and utilizing interfaces like **salesforce, QMP, Egnite etc. for accurate, real-time logs in LIMS and manual laboratory document maintenance.**
- **Replenished buffers, formulated reagents, cleaned equipment, and validated reagent efficacy, facilitating manufacturing and quality teams for smooth laboratory operations** and providing resources for team members' experiments.
- **Drove project success by prioritizing tasks, lead effective group discussions**, and engaged in one-on-one sessions with superiors to enhance personal and team development, and ensure timely project execution. **Trained newcomers and summer interns** to operate laboratory, and robots.
- Streamlined lab operations through expert calibration of equipment, reagent testing and validation, and mentorship of team members, ensuring **flawless execution** of complex assays on automated liquid analyzers. Reported deviations immediately to superiors for swift plans or actions for standardizing **SOP and QC adherence.**

Dominican University of California, San Rafael, MS-Biological Sciences

Aug 2019 to May 2021

Research Experience as A Graduate Student

- **Completed research-intensive master's program** to analyze susceptibility, symptom expressions, and transmission rate by plant pathogen on native ornamental plants at the **Dominican University of California at National Ornamental Research Site (NORS-DUC).**
- Analyzed susceptibility, symptom expressions, and transmission rate of plant pathogens on native ornamental plants at the National Ornamental Research Site (NORS-DUC), **integrating greenhouse experiments, laboratory experiments and field observations.**
- Mastered scientific writing and advanced biochemistry while preparing a **business case for a phase II clinical trial on small molecule 'deferiprone' for Parkinson's disease treatment.**
- Implemented **autoclaving, sterilization, and instrument calibration techniques, ensuring optimal functionality of lab equipment.**
- **Proficient in cell culturing, isolating and sorting to facilitate quantification of highly purified cells in 96 and 384-wells.**
- Inoculated the samples and quarantined the controls while learning **incubating and inoculating techniques under the hood for reducing contamination.**
- **Inducing spore production, staining the sporangia, and counting the spores using a hemocytometer, lyophilization of spores, speeding the mycelia growth by agar plug suspensions in broths.**
- Cleaned mycelia for **extracting DNA, isolating DNA (or enzymes for ELISA tests) for preparing the samples to run PCR.**
- **Running gel electrophoresis** on purified extracts to evaluate the amplicon sizes.
- Identified gene sequence using **BioEdit software** tool after analyzing PCR results.
- Created **phylogenetic tree using MegaX software and performed the phenotypic analysis from the images using Fiji ImageJ software.**
- Learnt and used **programing language R** for visual analysis of the data (3 way-ANOVA).
- Ensured **laboratory safety and glassware cleaning and maintenance**, adhering to protocols for handling reagents, buffers, and equipment with appropriate **personal protective equipment (PPE).**
- Developed proficiency in using **light microscopy, fluorescence microscopy, and scanning using electron microscopy.**